

Ceili Mor Academy of Dance

First Floor, 22 Luz Church Road, Mylapore, Chennai 600004

ARTS PROJECT GRANT APPLICATION

Grant programme	South Zone Cultural Centre, Performing Arts Project Grant 2026
Application ref	SZCC-PAG-2026-0188
Applicant organisation	Ceili Mor Academy of Dance (founded 2012)
Applicant / Artistic Director	Jean Mullen
PAN	AFLPM4471K
Project title	Five Elements
Amount requested	Rs 2,50,000
Total project budget	Rs 8,00,000
Submission date	12 February 2026

Project summary

Five Elements is a full-length contemporary Irish dance work in five movements, earth, water, fire, air, and ether, premiering at the Chennai Arts Festival in December 2026. It brings together the Munster tradition of Irish footwork, a contemporary movement language, live bodhran, voice, and fiddle, and integrated digital projection. The work is performed by the academy's advanced troupe of eight dancers and led in its Fire movement by senior student Emma Walsh.

Cultural significance

For fourteen years this academy has built contemporary Irish dance in Chennai, a genuine cross-cultural practice rather than an import. Five Elements is its most ambitious statement, a work that lets two traditions stand in one room and answer each other. The grant would help fund the projection design and musician fees that make the live, cross-disciplinary scale of the piece possible.

Use of grant funds (Rs 2,50,000 requested)

Line	Amount (Rs)
Digital projection design and mapping	1,20,000
Musician fees, three live players	90,000
Documentation and accessibility	40,000
Total requested	2,50,000

The balance of the Rs 8,00,000 budget is met from academy reserves and the festival performance fee. A full budget and the artistic director's CV are enclosed. The academy maintains audited accounts and can report on outcomes after the December premiere.